

Queensland University of Technology
Brisbane Australia

This may be the author's version of a work that was submitted/accepted for publication in the following source:

Gillett, Rosalie
(2023)
'This is not a nice safe space': investigating women's safety work on Tinder.
Feminist Media Studies, *23*(1), pp. 199-215.

This file was downloaded from: https://eprints.qut.edu.au/211445/

© 2021 Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group

This work is covered by copyright. Unless the document is being made available under a Creative Commons Licence, you must assume that re-use is limited to personal use and that permission from the copyright owner must be obtained for all other uses. If the document is available under a Creative Commons License (or other specified license) then refer to the Licence for details of permitted re-use. It is a condition of access that users recognise and abide by the legal requirements associated with these rights. If you believe that this work infringes copyright please provide details by email to qut.copyright@qut.edu.au

License: Creative Commons: Attribution-Noncommercial 4.0

Notice: *Please note that this document may not be the Version of Record (i.e. published version) of the work. Author manuscript versions (as Submitted for peer review or as Accepted for publication after peer review) can be identified by an absence of publisher branding and/or typeset appearance. If there is any doubt, please refer to the published source.*

https://doi.org/10.1080/14680777.2021.1948884

“This is not a nice safe space”: investigating women’s safety work on Tinder

Rosalie Gillett

ARC Centre of Excellence for Automated Decision-Making and Society, Queensland University of Technology, Brisbane, Australia

Abstract

As dating app use continues to rise, so too do women’s experiences of intrusion in digital dating contexts. The extent to which dating apps facilitate intimate intrusions—defined in this article as behaviour that makes women feel uneasy, uncomfortable, or unsafe—has been the subject of burgeoning scholarly and media attention. While this research provides important evidence for the range of intrusions women experience on dating apps, to date, little is known about how women protect themselves in digital dating contexts. Drawing on qualitative interview and walkthrough data, this research investigated the strategies women employ to protect themselves—referred to throughout this paper as “safety work”—from men’s intrusive behaviour on the dating app Tinder. Findings from this paper demonstrate the range of online and offline strategies women employ to respond to, avoid, and cope with men’s violence. Given the burden placed on women to protect themselves, this paper argues that women’s safety work limits their ability to participate freely on dating apps.

Keywords

Dating apps; Tinder; safety work; continuum of sexual violence; intimate intrusions

Introduction

Since its inception in 2012, the dating app Tinder has been scrutinized for its role in facilitating harassing and abusive behaviour. In November 2019, a New Zealand man was charged and convicted for the murder of Grace Millane after the pair met through the platform (Antonia Noori Farzan 2019). While few experiences facilitated by Tinder and other dating apps have led to such extreme physical violence, a small body of scholarly research (Janine Rowse, Caroline Bolt and Sanjeev Gaya 2020; Laura Thompson 2018) and mainstream media (Avani Dias, Ange McCormack and Ali Russell 2020), brings into focus the potential for unsafety and risk in digital dating contexts. To the extent that dating apps facilitate both online and in-person encounters, then, users adopt strategies at various stages of app use in an effort to stay safe (Kath Albury et al. 2019).

Drawing on qualitative interviews with 17 women about their experiences of intimate intrusions, this paper investigates the safety work women employ when using Tinder. In its original conception, (Elizabeth A. Stanko 1985, 1) defined intimate intrusions as behaviours that women experience as “intimidating, threatening, coercive or violent.” This article, however, adapts this understanding to account for the experiences that women may not experience as “intimidating, threatening, coercive or violent”, yet still make them feel uneasy, uncomfortable, or unsafe. Moreover, “safety work” is used to “describe the strategising and planning that women and girls undertake in responding to, avoiding and/or coping with men’s violence” (Liz Kelly cited in Fiona Vera-Gray 2016). To better

understand the range of women's safety work practices, the paper examines the online and offline strategies women employ during their everyday interactions with Tinder users.

This paper draws on the continuum of sexual violence to understand women's experiences of intimate intrusions on Tinder (Liz Kelly 1988). Following Vera-Gray (2016), I conceptualise women's safety work in these digital dating contexts as a form of "hidden labour", arguing that these practices limit women's ability to participate freely on dating apps. Importantly, this article focuses on heterosexual dating culture, because the women who participated in this study were seeking men on Tinder. Given that there are likely to be different dynamics that shape heterosexual and same-sex attracted relationships and hook-ups, research on same-sex attracted populations also justifies scholarly attention.

Heterosexual dating and hook-up culture

A large body of academic scholarship examines the dynamics of traditional heterosexual dating relationships and casual sexual encounters ("hook-ups") (Kathleen A. Bogle 2008; Christian Licoppe 2019; Valérie Théorêt et al. 2020). This research highlights the pervasive- ness of deeply gendered heteronormative scripts that shape how people behave and understand their roles in dating and hook-up contexts. Gender expectations that downplay women's desire (Heather Hensman Kettrey 2018) create an unbalanced power structure" whereby men's desires and needs take precedence over women's" (Julie A. Reid, Sinikka Elliott and Gretchen R. Webber 2011). This precedence, coupled with an emphasis on men's desire as uncontrollable (Licoppe 2019), can lead women to agree to unwanted sexual activity (Deborah L. Tolman 2002). At the same time, Kettrey (2018) observes that hetero-normative constructions of sexual subjectivity "cast young women as sexual gatekeepers who are to regulate the sexual advances of young men." Because women are expected to pre-empt men's behaviour, unwanted sexual behaviour may be construed as their fault (Helene Berman et al. 2000; Deborah L. Tolman 2002). Consistent with the dynamics of heterosexual dating relationships and hook-ups, research highlights the patriarchal hetero- sexual frameworks guide people's behaviour in online dating contexts (Millsom Henry- Waring and Jo Barraket 2008; Licoppe 2019; Megan Lindsay 2015). This places Tinder and other dating apps as important contexts to examine intrusive interactions.

Women's safety and abuse in digital dating contexts

Dating apps reproduce traditional and new safety concerns for users (Anthony McCosker et al. 2019; Diana C. Parry Petrychyn Jonathan and Corey W. Johnson 2020). Like offline dating and hook-up contexts, dating app users describe the potential for physical and sexual assault when meeting with relatively unknown people. Unlike traditional offline contexts, however, dating app users contend with the risk of unsafety facilitated by digital platforms' unique affordances. The ease with which users can communicate with others

through instant messaging services, for instance, means that perpetrators have the ability to repeatedly harass their targets (Rosalie Gillett 2019). Recent empirical research also indicates that dating app users associate risk and unsafety with unwanted sexual contact, and other forms of sexual harassment or predatory behaviour online (Kath Albury and Paul Byron 2016). Moreover, the

anonymity afforded by the internet contributes to fears that dating app users will misrepresent themselves online (Panteá Farvid and Kayla Aisher 2016; Kamarah Pooley and Hayley Boxall 2020). And while dating apps' geolocative functionality may help people establish meaningful relationships with nearby users, it can make women fear technology-facilitated stalking (Gillett 2019).

Ultimately, the extent to which dating apps can facilitate abuse justifies women's fear (Edmond P. H. Choi, Janet Y.H. Wong and Daniel Y.T. Fong 2018; Pooley and Boxall 2020; Rowse, Bolt and Gaya 2020; Frances Shaw 2016; Thompson 2018). Dating app users report being harassed and discriminated against (Albury et al. 2019), "catfished", cyberbullied (Carolyn Lauckner et al. 2019), and receiving unwanted sexual advances (Caitlin H. Douglass et al. 2018; Cristina Miguel 2018) when using the apps to date and hook- up. Monica Anderson, Emily A. Vogels and Erica Turner's (2020) United States based quantitative survey on online dating found that 57% of 18–24-year-old women who have used a dating website or app report to have been sent an unsolicited sexually explicit message or image, 44% have been called offensive names, and 19% have been threatened with physical violence through online dating services. Because dating apps facilitate in-person encounters, users also report physical and sexual violence (Meredith Jean Scannell 2019; Rowse, Bolt and Gaya 2020). Rowse, Bolt and Gaya's (2020) analysis of alleged sexual assaults from an Australian metropolitan clinical forensic medicine service reported that 14% of women were assaulted after in-person meetings with men they had met on dating apps. Significantly, these findings emphasise how dating apps can facilitate new forms of intrusion and amplify more conventional experiences of abuse.

Safety work

Feminist scholarship has long demonstrated the routine strategies women employ to avoid or cope with men's violence. Women take precautionary measures in public and private space as known men and unknown strangers may commit violent acts (Elizabeth A. Stanko 1985, 1993; Deborah L. Tolman, Brian R. Davis and Christian P. Bowman 2016). Many of the empirical studies to date on harassment and abuse focus on how women manage public experiences of street harassment from unknown men. The main strategies women employ to distance themselves from men's unwanted behaviours is through space, time (Rosalyn Shute, Larry Owens and Phillip Slee 2007), and attention diversion (Heather R. Hlavka 2014). Women also learn to pre-emptively employ safety work to avoid male escalation of violence (Fiona Vera-Gray 2017). Despite the ubiquity of this behaviour, Fiona Vera-Gray (2018, 80) notes that safety work is rarely acknowledged by those who employ it. One conclusion that can be drawn from this finding is that women take safety work for granted, that is, they do not see it as safety, rather, just "the way things are" (Vera- Gray 2018, 21). As a result, routine safety work, "[...] repeated over time, becomes habitual: it is absorbed into the body as a kind of hidden labour" (Vera-Gray 2016). Management strategies can therefore limit girls' and women's freedom as they adapt their behaviour through pre-empting potential intrusion (Vera-Gray 2016).

A burgeoning body of research examines the strategies dating app users adopt to feel safe in digital dating contexts. This research shows that because dating apps facilitate online and in-person encounters, users negotiate safety at different stages of app use (Albury et al. 2019). These studies have found that women critically assess profiles (Albury and Byron 2016; Miguel 2018) and look for "red flags" when interacting with users (Albury et al. 2019). The LGBTQ+ young people who participated in Paul Byron, Kath Albury and Tinonee Pym's (2020) work on safety and risk negotiation

on dating/hook-up apps described the importance of friendship practices in digital dating contexts. These young people shared information about dates and hook-ups with friends who they had on "stand by" in case they wanted to leave. Urszula Pruchniewska's (2020) study of cisgender women's experiences of Bumble shows that women strategically use the platform's affordances to avoid harassment and danger. This research importantly demonstrates the significant amount of labor protection strategies add to a woman's dating process. However, she finds that "because the harm prevention mindset is so rationalized and normalized, this additional labor is largely invisible" (Pruchniewska 2020, 2434).

The continuum of sexual violence

Analysis of this study is underpinned by the continuum of sexual violence (Kelly 1988). Kelly (1988) created the framework to provide a useful way to recognise and better understand women's experiences of sexual violence and the connections between them. The continuum challenges traditional understandings of abuse that hierarchize women's experiences based on legal codes (Kelly 1988). Moving beyond these restrictive standards, the continuum enables researchers to explore and better understand a range of harassing and abusive experiences, rather than single incidents and types of victimisation. This understanding is articulated by Fiona Vera-Gray (2014, 123) who points out that the "theorisation marked a shift in thinking, from a focus on individual forms of VAWG [violence against women and girls] as discrete categories to the recognition of commonality and connections between forms, impacts, responses and functions."

The continuum provides a useful lens to investigate women's safety work in digital dating contexts for two reasons. First, it illuminates the range of online and offline behaviours that women experience as intrusive when using dating apps. The continuum of sexual violence's:

> [. . .] breadth and flexibility creates a framework in which new experiences can be located and accurately understood as abusive—something which is especially important in this area where modes of perpetration rapidly change due to advances in technology (Clare McGlynn, Erika Rackley and Ruth Houghton 2017, 28).

This provides an opportunity to interrogate the commonalities between typical and everyday intrusions on dating apps and those that are widely recognised forms of abuse. As Liz Kelly (2012, xix) points out: "the everyday, routine intimate intrusions which were so key to the continuum have dropped off many agendas." Second, the continuum shows us how all experiences of abuse have cumulative effects that are as important as physical violence (Kelly 1988). From this understanding, we can see how women accumulate knowledge about men's intrusive behaviour, which they learn from a young age and carry with them throughout their lives (Vera-Gray 2018). Significant, then, is that the knowledge of potential intrusion leads women to expect and pre-empt male violence.

Research methods

The study formed part of a larger three-year project on women's experiences of intimate intrusions on Tinder. In this first stage of data collection, I downloaded Tinder and con- ducted a technical "walkthrough" (Ben Light, Jean Burgess and Stefanie Duguay 2016) of Tinder's mobile interface. On

Tinder, only users who mutually indicate interest in one another (what the platform terms a "match") can communicate through the app's instant messaging service. Users swipe left to communicate their disinterest or right to "like" users' profiles. In order to examine Tinder's technological architecture, I created two accounts for the purposes of the research and "swiped right" on these profiles. I then configured the research accounts to limit the number of "real" user profiles I was exposed to. For instance, as an app that uses geo-locative technology to connect people who are in close proximity to one another, I restricted the maximum distance between users to five kilometres. Once I had the ability to send private messages between these accounts, I examined Tinder's private messaging service, report and "unmatch" mechanisms. I then deleted the research accounts after I completed the technical walkthrough. Findings from the walkthrough gave me important insight into the platform's infrastructure and technical affordances, which enabled me to tailor sections of the interview schedule.

To supplement the technical walkthrough of Tinder's interface, I examined popular media articles about the platform (see for example, Kristian Silva 2016), social media pages (see for example, Tinder Nightmares 2021), Tinder's blog, Terms of Use, marketing materials including information on the Apple App Store, and promotional YouTube videos. These materials generated rich background information on Tinder's affordances and representation in ancillary media. While the walkthrough method affords a framework to investigate an app, this method cannot show how users engage with platforms (Stefanie Duguay 2016; Ben Light 2016). To understand how users engage with Tinder's technological interface, I paired the walkthrough with semi-structured interviews.

In the second stage of data collection, I interviewed seventeen 18–30-year-old women who were living in Brisbane, Australia and had experienced behaviour on Tinder that made them feel uneasy, uncomfortable, or unsafe. During the semi-structured in-person interviews, I asked participants about their experiences of intimate intrusions on Tinder, how they understood their experiences, and what steps they took to mitigate intrusive behaviour. To protect the identities of the women who participated in the research, I use pseudonyms throughout the paper. I also made the decision not to collect demographic data about the participants. Given that the women were living in a relatively small city and read direct messages from Tinder users they had received, I decided that demographic information had the potential to hinder their safety. The data were thematically analysed following Virginia Braun and Victoria Clarke's (2006) "phases of thematic analysis", using both open and axial coding techniques for a comprehensive and flexible analysis (Jennifer Fereday and Eimear Muir-Cochrane 2006). The remainder of this article thematically examines how the women who participated in the study employed safety work during their Tinder use.

How women use Tinder's safety features

Of Tinder's safety features, the women who participated in this study described using the app's unmatch mechanism to limit further with other users. For Lara, the ability to unmatch users was important when dealing with intrusive messages: "I consider that more on the minor end, it's still sexual abuse, but at least if it's just someone saying that stuff over a message, you can report them and unmatch them and then it's all over." While Tinder allows users to report those who break the platform's rules (in both online and offline contexts), most of these women did not report their

experiences of intrusion to the platform. Penelope did not want to "overreact" to her encounter with a man in an isolated park at night:

> it wasn't a huge deal, [. . .] I didn't really report him to Tinder or anything like that, because I was safe, but maybe I should've because I don't know if he does that to other people as well.

The women's limited reporting of intimate intrusions aligns with the findings that most harassment and sexual violence is not reported to the authorities (Bianca Fileborn 2018; Anastasia Powell and Nicola Henry 2016). Research on the invalidation of women's experiences of sexual violence has found that women do not want to be seen making a "fuss about nothing" (Liz Kelly and Jill Radford 1990, 46). Adding to the problem, Tinder's (now updated) obscure report button may have contributed "to the sense that reporting others was a rare act" (Stefanie Duguay, Jean Burgess and Nicolas P. Suzor 2018, 8).

For some women, the commonness of intimate intrusions facilitated by Tinder shaped their use of the platform's reporting mechanism:

> Yeah and you know what? I didn't even think to report it. Like, it's not that uncommon for, sort of, similar things to happen. Like, if he had have said, "I'm gonna fucking kill you" or something more serious, in inverted commas, maybe I would have, but I should have, but I don't know, it just didn't cross my mind at the time. (Kimberly)

Kimberly's admission that reporting the behaviour "just didn't cross [her] mind" captures the everyday occurrence of intrusion. Given the ubiquity of misogynistic behaviour online (Emma A. Jane 2017), there is a good argument that women have become tolerant of it (Jessica Vitak et al. 2017). Similar to offline contexts (see, for example, Berman et al. 2000; Kelly 1988), the women's reports suggest intimate intrusions on Tinder are unpleasant but ordinary, expected, and normalised. It may therefore be the case that the ordinariness of intrusion shapes women's reporting decisions and other safety precautions they take.

Some of the women I interviewed, however, did not know that Tinder had a reporting mechanism, as Georgia explained: "I don't know if I reported it to Tinder. I'm trying to remember what the report function was." She continued: "Yeah and I mean I would've assumed that if I could've reported it, I would. But I don't remember if I . . . if I actively did." The women's limited use of Tinder's reporting mechanism illustrated the inadequacy of the feature. At the time of the research interviews, the report button was hidden by three red dots in the corner of the screen. It is therefore unsurprising that the women had not engaged with such a nondescript button, as Duguay, Burgess and Suzor (2018) also found.

Of the women who did use the reporting mechanism, they most often described using it only for users who engaged in behaviour they thought were particularly intrusive: "[. . .] I think one was really, really offensive and I think I reported his inappropriate messaging, but yeah, apart from that I just unmatched them" (Becky). Similarly, Jade said: "if it was about my weight, I'd report them. Depending on how explicit a sexual comment might be, I'd report them." Implicit in their responses is the understanding that only experiences of intrusion that would be considered "serious" to other people

should be reported. This is a shared understanding for a range of victims of crime (Adam M. Watkins 2005).

Among the women who did report their experiences of intrusion to the platform, Tinder's lack of responsiveness led them to believe no action had been taken. Rachel, for instance, received no response from Tinder when she reported a user who clearly broke the platform's rules. Other studies have similarly found that dating apps do little to respond to user reports (Albury et al. 2019). More still, Rachel saw the man she reported on the platform only several days after she had made the report, which suggested to her that Tinder had not enforced its Terms of Service. Ultimately, when Tinder fails to respond to reports and enforce its rules, it sends a message to users that intrusive behaviour is acceptable, and that women's reports are unjustified. This is important because how digital platforms respond to behaviour can impact how people behave online (Sarah Myers West 2018). Indeed, there is a real risk that Tinder's perceived failure to respond to reports conditions users to limit their use of the platform's safety features (Albury et al. 2019).

How women assess men's Tinder profiles

As part of the women's ongoing routine safety work, some took more time to analyse Tinder users' profiles. Participants used various "uncertainty reduction strategies" (Jennifer L. Gibbs, Nicole B. Ellison and Chih-Hui Lai 2011), or what Farvid and Aisher (2016) refer to as "detective work" to try to understand users and their motivations. As others have noted, the potential for abuse facilitated by dating apps can lead women to be particularly selective in deciding who to interact with (Miguel 2018). The current study extends Albury and Byron's (2016) research, which observed how same-sex attracted young people negotiate risks on hook-up apps by through close readings of user profiles. As Ariel said: "I definitely look at their profile to try and ascertain what are their purposes for being on there?" Becky made, what she considered to be, a connection between user photographs and motivations for using Tinder:

> [. . .] there were lots of profiles coming up where the guys are standing completely naked with their bum to the camera in any situation you could think of. And it was like, okay, I don't know if that's a new trend, or whatever, but from those kind of pictures you can already kind of guess that they might be a bit more fun orientated, maybe, maybe that's not true, but that would be a connection I'd make.

As Becky's account indicates, many women thought men were using Tinder for casual hook-ups. This finding echoes Pruchniewska's (2020) research, which shows us how women "weed out harassers on Bumble." At the same time, Becky's insight illustrates the conflation of intimate intrusions with casual hook-ups.

Even after the women began communicating with other users, they reported investigating users for "red flags" (Albury et al. 2019). Keira tried to understand a user's character by questioning their political ideologies, specifically asking whether or not they would have voted for Donald Trump in the 2016 United States presidential election. Ultimately, the women's analyses of users' motivations and character led them to be wary of men using the platform. Some of the women believed that men who presented as caring or in other ways desirable had deceptively crafted their profiles. These women's understanding that men may conceal their motivations for using Tinder created a paradoxical situation

for them. While they were looking for caring men, their assumptions led them to question men who presented in this way. Although the reason for this is unclear, Penelope described a frightening experience where a Tinder match incessantly text messaged and called her. At first, Penelope considered him to be "really caring" and "sweet." As he continued to contact her, though, she came to understand his behaviour as deceptive and designed to entice her into hooking up with him. Her analysis of the man's motivations therefore led to her more general suspicion of men's behaviour: "if they seem really sweet and nice and kind, they're definitely not what they seem."

Cross-platform convergence

The women in this study sought to establish the authenticity of Tinder users through negotiations of users' cross-platform self-presentations. The majority of the women described investigating their matches on a range of social media platforms to determine whether or not the men were "real" or genuinely representing their physical appearances on their Tinder profiles. Some of this safety work, what I refer to as cross-platform convergence, was, in part, made possible by Tinder's cross-platform linking feature, which enables users to link their Instagram and Spotify accounts to their Tinder profiles. The ability for users to link their social media accounts enables potential "matches" to establish and negotiate authenticity (Stefanie Duguay 2016). Although men's ostensibly genuine representations of their appearances were important to the women in this study, they also relied on Tinder's cross-platform linking feature to assess men's characters. As other studies have found (see, for example, Albury and Byron 2016; Pruchniewska 2020), Keira thought that images shared on Instagram could provide valuable insight about a user's character: "do they have friends and stuff in their photos, or what kind of stuff do they share? There was one guy actually that posted basically a men's rights activist thing on his Instagram and I just unmatched [him] straight away." Keira's strategy demonstrates how the sharing of images can generate important insights about a person's values and beliefs.

From its inception, users have understood Facebook as a platform where others create profiles that are tied to their "authentic" identities. This may be, in part, because users communicate with those whom they have offline relationships with (Emily Van der Nagel 2017). Indeed, the women in this study consistently searched for and viewed Tinder users' Facebook profiles to allay their authenticity concerns (see also Stefanie Duguay 2016). In their chapter on user experiences on Tinder and other location-aware apps, Jenna Condie, Garth Lean and Donna James (2018) found that to build trust in other users, women employ more strategies to—what one of their interviewees referred to as—"stalk" and stay safe. While stalking has traditionally been used to describe abusive behaviour (Evan Stark 2012), this terminology has been adopted as an internet colloquialism (see also Pruchniewska 2020). More specifically, "Facebook stalking" has been used to describe "the increasingly common practice of digging through digital information on the social network site Facebook to reveal information about others" (Alice E. Marwick 2012, 380). In this study, Penelope explained how she would ask for her Tinder matches' Facebook profiles to determine "what they're actually like in real life." Individuals may therefore consider online profiles more authentic when they are tethered to their personal net- works (Nancy K. Baym 2015).

Significant, however, is that while the women used cross-platform convergence as a way to manage their safety, they limited their use of Tinder's cross-platform linking affordance. Indeed, there is a real

risk that linking social media accounts leaks too much personal information (Farvid and Aisher 2016; Pruchniewska 2020) and makes a user more visible to those who they do not want to connect with (Albury et al. 2019). All of the women in the current study who had linked other social media accounts described removing them following intrusion. Lara, for instance, described how she felt after removing the link to her Instagram account: "it's kind of decreased the amount of message requests I get on Instagram. So I feel a lot safer on Instagram now." While the ability to share personal information online, then, can play an important role in allaying concerns and establishing trust between Tinder users, features including cross-platform linking may simultaneously facilitate unwanted behaviour (Albury and Byron 2016). Indeed, the majority of the women in this study reported receiving unsolicited "dick pics" from users when they connected on other social media platforms. As a result, the women had to negotiate their own attempts to convey authenticity while bearing the risk of intrusion.

These findings demonstrate that despite the women using cross-platform linking to view users' profiles on other platforms, the behaviour made them feel uncomfortable when men used similar strategies. One interpretation of this finding may be that cross- platform convergence is more disturbing to women in the context of their common experiences of intrusion on Tinder, reflecting "a recognition of their vulnerability as women to men's behavior and thus to the possibility of male violence" (Stanko 1985, 11). A point of difference should also be noted between the women in the study and other Tinder users' cross-platform convergence strategies. While participants viewed Tinder users' various social media profiles to allay their authenticity concerns, they generally did so passively, not attempting to communicate with men through these channels.

Importantly, how social media platforms connect meant that the women needed to consider the affordances of various platforms. Mia described how cross-platform linking to Instagram could enable Tinder users to view other users' locations: "in Instagram, if you share your location when you're sharing your photos, you can go to the actual house number." Similarly, Francesca described Snapchat's "Snap Map", which enables live location-sharing between Snapchat users. She was reminded of the platform's location- sharing ability when a Tinder user claimed to be in a park near her home:

> if you're connected on Snapchat, you can actually see where people are. [. . .] So when that guy had said that he was down the road from my house, because we were connected on Snapchat, you could actually see exactly where I was. (Francesca)

The women's experiences affirm the potential risks of location-sharing technology (see also Albury and Byron 2016). Women can thus be burdened with managing the geo- locative affordances of various platforms to prevent users from "simply 'turning up' as women go about their day" (Anastasia Powell and Nicola Henry 2017, 41). This functions as a form of "hidden labour" (Vera-Gray 2016), which women are expected to navigate in order to stay safe (Bridget A. Harris and Delanie Woodlock 2019).

Negotiating safety for in-person encounters

Since Tinder facilitates in-person interactions between users, the women employed safety work when meeting users offline. This safety work highlighted traditional hetero- normative frameworks that emphasise men's desire as uncontrollable (Licoppe 2019), and women's roles as sexual gatekeepers (Kettrey 2018). Becky, for instance, described meeting with men in public places and dressing conservatively, so as not to give men "the wrong idea" (Becky). Similar to Albury and Byron's (2016) findings, participants in the current study did not explicitly mention their use of their mobile phones to call for help. However, when Francesca went on dates with Tinder users, she described using her mobile phone's "pin drop" function, which enables location-sharing to other mobile users. Francesca said she would use this function to send her friends her location while on a Tinder date. Similarly, other women described sending their Tinder dates' phone numbers and locations of dates to their friends. How these women shared this information shows that friendship can be an important practice of safer app use (see also, Byron, Albury and Pym 2020). These findings also support and extend Petrychyn Jonathan and Johnson's (2020, 252) work about how dating app users establish "an intimate network of support around them." At the same time, the women's use of technology in this way illustrates how social media affordances, and new technologies more broadly, can be used for protection (Walter S. DeKeseredy, Molly Dragiewicz and Martin D. Schwartz 2017).

For some of the women, their safety work was reaffirmed after they experienced intrusion in an offline setting. Following an incident with a man who assaulted her at his home, Georgia explained:

> I think it made me re-evaluate the way that I use the app. So yeah, I'd never go somewhere where we were alone, even if it was like . . . if someone was gonna say 'hey let's go for a walk on the beach,' I'd probably be like, "let's go to a café."

Men's intimate intrusions in physical settings especially sensitised the women to the potential for further physical violence. Lara described the changes she made to her behaviour after a man assaulted her:

> I don't really like going out by myself anymore now. I always like to have an extra set of eyes with me. If I'm on a date, or something, and I don't feel safe I'll call a friend and I'll ask them: "hey, can you just come to this place and keep an eye on what happens?"

Lara's comment highlights her increased sensitisation to intrusive behaviour through her concern for her safety in public spaces. Importantly, her admission: "I don't really like going out by myself anymore" demonstrates how she carries the threat of male violence throughout her life, not just in dating contexts. This importantly shows us how women accumulate knowledge about men's violence, which can impede women's dating and also contribute to a more generalised fear in public space (Kelly 1988). As others have found (see Stanko 1993), this fear can limit women's movements in public space.

Significant, however, is the finding that the women sometimes felt obligated to interact with Tinder users in ways that conflicted with their learnt safety work strategies. For instance, while several of the women did not want to go on dates—or they at least felt uncomfortable about doing so—they eventually gave in to the men's requests. Of the women who did meet with men in-person, they overwhelmingly thought it was important to meet with Tinder users in public places, but they also felt

pressured to meet in private. As Francesca said when she described allowing a man to pick her up for a date:

> I just thought it was weird. I even questioned my friend, and I was like "that's weird, he wants to pick me up." I was like, it's nice, but really? For a first date? [. . .] even though you might think it's a bit weird or feel a little bit uncomfortable about it, you kind of just roll with it, right?

While Francesca felt uncomfortable, she also understood the man's (what could be interpreted as controlling) behaviour as "nice." This importantly shows that men's behaviour that makes women feel uneasy, uncomfortable, or unsafe, may not be recognised as "criminal" by legal codes (Kelly 1988). Francesca's discomfort was validated when the man forcefully kissed her and pulled her hair during the encounter.

While it is unclear why the women acted in ways that competed with their learnt safety work practices, there is a good argument that social expectations associated with dating and Tinder use shaped the women's behaviour (Licoppe 2019). According to Lindsay Ferris and Stefanie Duguay (2020), Tinder's focal swipe functionality reinforces an emphasis on meeting up with users. Indeed, many of the women reported feeling obligated to engage in sexual activity with Tinder users. As Keira explained: "I did feel pressure when going on dates with these guys to have sex with them. Cause I was like well, I met him on Tinder, this is what they expect." Keira's admission demonstrates how Tinder's deep- seated connection to casual sex carries expectations of its users (Duguay, Burgess and Suzor 2018). This finding also builds on prior dating and hook-up research that demonstrates how deeply entrenched heteronormative frameworks can lead women to place men's desires over their own and agree to unwanted sexual activity (Henry-Waring and Barraket 2008; Reid, Elliott and Webber 2011).

Social norms of politeness could have also played a role in shaping the women's decisions to engage in unwanted sexual activity. As Donna Chung (2007) identified in her study of young women's experiences and understandings of dating violence, a common harassment and unwanted attention management strategy her interviewees employed was to be polite and not offend the men who engaged in the behaviour. It is therefore reasonable to suggest that the women in this study were cautious not to offend their Tinder dates, even if this meant behaving in ways that made them feel uncomfor- table. However, women may turn to more indirect strategies to protect themselves (Celia Kitzinger and Hannah Frifth 1999), as Georgia did when she explained to a man who she reluctantly met with at his home: "by the way, I got my period."

Given the burdensome safety work that these women employed, it is notable that they used Tinder to date and hook-up. Notwithstanding men's intrusive behaviour, the majority of the participants described using Tinder because they wanted to establish meaningful connections with men. As Hannah said: "there's plenty of pricks and there's plenty potential for disaster, but there is also somebody you might click with." There was also a sense among the women that using platforms to date and hook-up could potentially be safer than meeting men offline. Keira thought that men's intrusive behaviour on the platform gave her important insight into their attitudes toward women that she might not have garnered from men she met offline. She said:

> I think if they behave like that on Tinder than they would behave like that in real-life. Even if it's like they wouldn't necessarily go up to you in the bar, but if they think it's okay to talk to you like that [on Tinder], they're eventually going to pull out those attitudes. (Keira)

For Keira, then, Tinder afforded her a fast-tracked opportunity to understand the motives and attitudes of the men she matched with. This finding importantly shows that women carry with them the potential for male violence as they go about their lives (Vera-Gray 2018).

Turning off Tinder

Ultimately, though, if the women felt as though they could not mitigate intimate intrusions, they temporarily or permanently suspended their Tinder accounts. This is not unlike how women retreat from a range of online spaces to prevent ongoing harm (see Lik Sam Chan 2018; Emma A. Jane 2017; Vitak et al. 2017). A range of intimate intrusions triggered the women's response to leave Tinder. For Josie, in-person encounters prompted her to limit her Tinder use. She recalled how she felt after engaging in casual sex with men she had met on the service:

> it made me feel like a piece of meat. It made me feel like I wasn't . . . I wasn't worth anything else, I was just . . . a sex toy basically. [. . .] So I stopped using Tinder because I realised they're not here for any sort of decent conversation or anything.

After receiving intrusive messages, some women deleted their accounts and uninstalled Tinder from their mobile phones. As Keira explained: "I don't use it anymore, so that's how I minimise it, I just don't use it," she continued, "I'm just like no, this is not a nice safe space." Keira's admission aligns with the knowledge that women "isolate themselves in private to avoid danger" (Stanko 1993, 123). It also provides evidence for the ways that women accumulate knowledge about men's violence (Kelly 1988). Importantly, while the women may have considered circumscribing their Tinder use a reasonable strategy to protect themselves, this limited their freedom to participate online in ways that they preferred. As Emma A. Jane (2017, 5) puts it: "[. . .] while women who withdraw from the internet to avoid threats and harassment are making a rational choice, it is not a free choice because they are coerced into making these changes."

Conclusion

The women's experiences—coupled with the walkthrough findings—in this study pro- vide important contextual data about the safety work strategies women use to stay safe on Tinder. This research extends research on safety work in offline (Vera-Gray 2018) and online spaces (Harris and Woodlock 2019), which shows us how it is absorbed by girls and women as a kind of hidden labour (Vera-Gray 2016). The women's knowledge of men's intrusive behaviour shaped how they used Tinder and how they interacted with other users. In pre-empting intimate intrusions, the women were burdened with considering how other social media platforms' permeable or "porous boundaries" (Jenny L. Davis and

Nathan Jurgenson 2014) could leak their personal information and make them more easily contactable. This research therefore provides further support for the continuum of sexual violence (Kelly 1988), which helps us to understand how women accumulate knowledge about men's violence.

Since this study focused on women's experiences in heterosexual dating relationships, future research should investigate same-sex attracted women's experiences as it is likely that there will be different dynamics that justify scholarly attention.

In this study, the women's safety work was complicated by social expectations associated with Tinder use and the platform's affordances. Based on these findings, it is reasonable to suggest that how women employ safety work on Tinder is not the neat work it may appear to be. Rather, it may be better understood as a complex process of management and negotiation. This raises important questions surrounding Tinder's culture and affordances, and how they may shape user behaviour. Importantly, Tinder has updated its reporting mechanism—with the button now depicted as a red flag—and implemented a suite of new safety features. While these changes indicate that the company is taking its users' safety more seriously, further research is needed to examine how effectively they enable women to feel safe.

Acknowledgments

The author would like to thank the anonymous reviewers, those who provided feedback related to the research, and the women who shared their experiences.

Disclosure statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author(s).

Notes on contributor

Rosalie Gillett is a Postdoctoral Research Fellow in the QUT node of the ARC Centre of Excellence for Automated Decision-Making and Society. Her research sits at the intersection between online gender-based violence, automation, and platform governance. E-mail: rosalie.gillett@qut.edu.au

ORCID

Rosalie Gillett http://orcid.org/0000-0002-1437-8050

References

Albury, Kath, and Paul Byron. 2016. "Safe on My Phone? Same-Sex Attracted Young People's Negotiations of Intimacy, Visibility, and Risk on Digital Hook-Up Apps." *Social Media and Society* 2 (4): 1–10.

Albury, Kath, Paul Byron, Anthony McCosker, Tinonee Pym, Jarrod Walshe, Kane Race, and Doreen Salon, et al. 2019. "Safety, Risk and Wellbeing on Dating Apps: Final Report." https:// apo.org.au/node/268156

Anderson, Monica, Emily A. Vogels, and Erica Turner. 2020. "The Virtues and Downsides of Online Dating." https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/2020/02/06/the-virtues-and-downsides-of- online-dating/

Baym, Nancy K. 2015. *Personal Connections in the Digital Age*. 2nd ed. Cambridge: Polity Press. Berman, Helene, Katherine McKenna, Carrie Traher Arnold, Gail Taylor, and MacQuarrie Barbara. 2000. "Sexual

Harassment: Everyday Violence in the Lives of Girls and Women." *Advances in Nursing Science* 22 (4): 32–46. doi:10.1097/00012272-200006000-00004.

Bogle, Kathleen A. 2008. *Hooking Up: Sex, Dating, and Relationships on Campus*. New York: New York University Press.

Braun, Virginia, and Victoria Clarke. 2006. "Using Thematic Analysis in Psychology." *Qualitative Research in Psychology* 3 (2): 77–101. doi:10.1191/1478088706qp063oa.

Byron, Paul, Kath Albury, and Tinonee Pym. 2020. "Hooking up with Friends: LGBTQ+ Young People, Dating Apps, Friendship and Safety." *Media, Culture and Society* 43 (3): 1–18. Chan, Lik Sam. 2018. "Liberating or Disciplining? A Technofeminist Analysis of the Use of Dating Apps among Women in Urban China." *Communication Culture and Critique* 11 (2): 298–314. doi:10.1093/ccc/tcy004.

Choi, Edmond P. H., Janet Y.H. Wong, and Daniel Y.T. Fong. 2018. "An Emerging Risk Factor of Sexual Abuse: The Use of Smartphone Dating Applications." *Sexual Abuse* 30 (4): 343–366. doi:10.1177/1079063216672168.

Chung, Donna. 2007. "Making Meaning of Relationships: Young Women's Experiences and Understandings of Dating Violence." *Violence Against Women* 13 (12): 1274–1295. doi:10.1177/1077801207310433.

Condie, Jenna, Garth Lean, and Donna James. 2018. "Tinder Matters: Swiping Right to Unlock Research Fields." In *Doing Research in and on the Digital: Research Methods across Fields of Inquiry*, edited by Cristina Costa and Jenna Condie, 102–115. London: Routledge.

Davis, Jenny L., and Nathan Jurgenson. 2014. "Context Collapse: Theorizing Context Collusions and Collisions." *Information, Communication and Society* 17 (4): 476–485. doi:10.1080/1369118X.2014.888458.

DeKeseredy, Walter S., Molly Dragiewicz, and Martin D. Schwartz. 2017. *Abusive Endings: Separation and Divorce Violence against Women*. Oakland: University of California Press.

Dias, Avani, Ange McCormack, and Ali Russell. 2020. "Unmatched: How Tinder Fails to Act on Sexual Assault." *ABC News*, October 12. https://www.abc.net.au/news/2020-10-12/tinder-dating-app-helps-sexual-predators-hide-four-corners/12722732

Douglass, Caitlin H., Cassandra J.C. Wright, Angela C. Davis, and Megan S.C. Lim. 2018. "Correlates of In-Person and Technology-Facilitated Sexual Harassment from an Online Survey among Young Australians." *Sexual Health* 15 (4): 361–365. doi:10.1071/SH17208.

Duguay, Stefanie. 2016. "Dressing up Tinderella: Interrogating Authenticity Claims on the Mobile Dating App Tinder." *Information, Communication and Society* 20 (3): 351–367. doi:10.1080/1369118X.2016.1168471.

Duguay, Stefanie, Jean Burgess, and Nicolas P. Suzor. 2018. "Queer Women's Experiences of Patchwork Platform Governance on Tinder, Instagram, and Vine." *Convergence* 26 (2): 237–252. doi:10.1177/1354856518781530.

Farvid, Panteá, and Kayla Aisher. 2016. "'It's Just a Lot More Casual': Young Heterosexual Women's Experience of Using Tinder in New Zealand." *Ada: A Journal of Gender, New Media, and Technology* 10.

Farzan, Antonia Noori. 2019. "'You Can't Consent to Your Own Murder': Jury Rejects Rough-sex Defense in Backpacker's Death." *The Washington Post*, November 22. https://www.washingtonpost.com/nation/2019/11/22/grace-millane-murder-trial-guilty-verdict-new-zealand-backpacker-tinder/

Fereday, Jennifer, and Eimear Muir-Cochrane. 2006. "Demonstrating Rigor Using Thematic Analysis: A Hybrid Approach Using Inductive and Deductive Coding and Theme Development." *International Journal of Qualitative Methods* 5 (1): 80–92. doi:10.1177/160940690600500107.

Ferris, Lindsay, and Stefanie Duguay. 2020. "Tinder's Lesbian Digital Imaginary: Investigating (Im) permeable Boundaries of Sexual Identity on a Popular Dating App." *New Media and Society* 22 (3): 489–506. doi:10.1177/1461444819864903.

Fileborn, Bianca. 2018. "Naming the Unspeakable Harm of Street Harassment: A Survey-Based Examination of Disclosure Practices." *Violence Against Women* 25 (2): 223–248. doi:10.1177/ 1077801218768709.

Gibbs, Jennifer L., Nicole B. Ellison, and Chih-Hui Lai. 2011. "First Comes Love, Then Comes Google: An Investigation of Uncertainty Reduction Strategies and Self-Disclosure in Online Dating." *Communication Research* 38 (1): 70–100. doi:10.1177/0093650210377091.

Gillett, Rosalie. 2019. "Everyday Violence: Women's Experiences of Intimate Intrusions on Tinder." PhD thesis, Queensland University of Technology. https://eprints.qut.edu.au/131121/2/Rosalie_ Gillett_Thesis.pdf

Harris, Bridget A., and Delanie Woodlock. 2019. "Digital Coercive Control: Insights from Two Landmark Domestic Violence Studies." *The British Journal of Criminology* 59 (3): 530–550. doi:10.1093/bjc/azy052.

Henry-Waring, Millsom, and Jo Barraket. 2008. "Dating and Intimacy in the 21st Century: The Use of Online Dating Sites in Australia." *International Journal of Emerging Technologies and Society* 6 (1): 14–33.

Hlavka, Heather R. 2014. "Normalizing Sexual Violence: Young Women Account for Harassment and Abuse." *Gender and Society* 28 (3): 337–358. doi:10.1177/0891243214526468.

Jane, Emma A. 2017. *Misogyny Online: A Short (And Brutish) History*. London: SAGE Publications . Kelly, Liz. 1988. *Surviving Sexual Violence*. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press. Kelly, Liz. 2012. "Standing the Test of Time? Reflections on the Concept of the Continuum of Sexual Violence." In *Handbook on Sexual Violence*, edited by Jennifer Brown and Sandra Walklate, xvii– xxvi. London: Routledge.

Kelly, Liz, and Jill Radford. 1990. ""Nothing Really Happened": The Invalidation of Women's Experiences of Sexual Violence." *Critical Social Policy* 10 (30): 39–53. doi:10.1177/ 026101839001003003.

Kettrey, Heather Hensman. 2018. ""Bad Girls" Say No and "Good Girls" Say Yes: Sexual Subjectivity and Participation in Undesired Sex during Heterosexual College Hookups." *Sexuality & Culture* 22 (3): 685–705. doi:10.1007/s12119-018-9498-2.

Kitzinger, Celia, and Hannah Frifth. 1999. "Just Say No? The Use of Conversation Analysis in Developing a Feminist Perspective on Sexual Refusal." *Discourse and Society* 10 (3): 293–316. doi:10.1177/0957926599010003002.

Lauckner, Carolyn, Natalia Truszczynski, Danielle Lambert, Varsha Kottamasu, Saher Meherally, Anne Marie Schipani-McLaughlin, Erica Taylor, and Nathan Hansen. 2019. ""Catfishing," Cyberbullying, and Coercion: An Exploration of the Risks Associated with Dating App Use among Rural Sexual Minority Males." *Journal of Gay & Lesbian Mental Health* 23 (3): 289–306. doi:10.1080/ 19359705.2019.1587729.

Licoppe, Christian. 2019. "Liquidity and Attachment in the Mobile Hookup Culture. A Comparative Study of Contrasted Interactional Patterns in the Main Uses of Grindr and Tinder." *Journal of Cultural Economy* 13 (1): 73–90. doi:10.1080/17530350.2019.1607530.

Light, Ben. 2016. "The Rise of Speculative Devices: Hooking up with the Bots of Ashley Madison." *First Monday* 21: 6.

Light, Ben, Jean Burgess, and Stefanie Duguay. 2016. "The Walkthrough Method: An Approach to the Study of Apps." *New Media and Society* 20 (3): 881–900. doi:10.1177/1461444816675438. Lindsay, Megan. 2015. "Performative Acts of Gender in Online Dating: An Autoethnography Comparing Sites." In *Online Courtship: Interactions Across Borders*, edited by I. Alev Degim, James Johnson, and Fu. Tao, 242–261. Carbondale, IL: Institute of Network Cultures.

Marwick, Alice E. 2012. "The Public Domain: Social Surveillance in Everyday Life." *Surveillance & Society* 9 (4): 378–393. doi:10.24908/ss.v9i4.4342.

McCosker, Anthony, Kath Albury, Tinonee Pym, Paul Byron, and Kane Race. 2019. "Swiping, Stealthing and Catfishing: Dating and Hookup Apps in the Media." https://apo.org.au/sites/ default/files/resource-files/2019-09/apo-nid258941.pdf

McGlynn, Clare, Erika Rackley, and Ruth Houghton. 2017. "Beyond 'Revenge Porn': The Continuum of Image-Based Sexual Abuse." *Feminist Legal Studies* 25 (1): 25–46. doi:10.1007/s10691-017- 9343-2.

Miguel, Cristina. 2018. "Meeting People Online." In *Personal Relationships and Intimacy in the Age of Social Media*, edited by Cristina Miguel, 103–123. London: Palgrave Pivot.

Petrychyn Jonathan, Diana C. Parry, and Corey W. Johnson. 2020. "Building Community, One Swipe at a Time: Hook-Up Apps and the Production of Intimate Publics between Women." *Health Sociology Review* 29 (3): 249–263.

Pooley, Kamarah, and Hayley Boxall. 2020. "Mobile Dating Applications and Sexual and Violent Offending." *The Australian Institute of Criminology*. https://www.aic.gov.au/publications/tandi/ tandi612

Powell, Anastasia, and Nicola Henry. 2016. "Technology-Facilitated Sexual Violence Victimization: Results from an Online Survey of Australian Adults." *Journal of Interpersonal Violence* 34 (17): 3637–3665. doi:10.1177/0886260516672055.

Powell, Anastasia, and Nicola Henry. 2017. *Sexual Violence in a Digital Age*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.

Pruchniewska, Urszula. 2020. ""I like that It's My Choice a Couple Different Times": Gender, Affordances, and User Experience on Bumble Dating." *International Journal of Communication* 14: 2422–2439.

Reid, Julie A., Sinikka Elliott, and Gretchen R. Webber. 2011. "Casual Hookups to Formal Dates: Refining the Boundaries of the Sexual Double Standard." *Gender and Society* 25 (5): 545–568. doi:10.1177/0891243211418642.

Rowse, Janine, Caroline Bolt, and Sanjeev Gaya. 2020. “Swipe Right: The Emergence of Dating-App Facilitated Sexual Assault. A Descriptive Retrospective Audit of Forensic Examination Caseload in an Australian Metropolitan Service.” *Forensic Science, Medicine, and Pathology* 16 (1): 71–77. doi:10.1007/s12024-019-00201-7.

Scannell, Meredith Jean. 2019. “Online Dating and the Risk of Sexual Assault to College Students.” *Building Healthy Academic Communities Journal* 3 (1): 34–43. doi:10.18061/bhac.v3i1.6688.

Shaw, Frances. 2016. ““Bitch I Said Hi”: The Bye Felipe Campaign and Discursive Activism in Mobile Dating Apps.” *Social Media and Society* 2 (4): 1–10.

Shute, Rosalyn, Larry Owens, and Phillip Slee. 2007. “Everyday Victimization of Adolescent Girls by Boys: Sexual Harassment, Bullying or Aggression?” *Sex Roles* 58 (7–8): 477–489. doi:10.1007/ s11199-007-9363-5.

Silva, Kristian. 2016. “The Tinder Date and the Fatal Fall.” *ABC News*, October 20. https://www.abc.net.au/news/2016-10-20/the-story-of-gable-tostee-and-warriena-wrights-tragic-date/7941720
Stanko, Elizabeth A. 1985. *Intimate Intrusions: Women’s Experiences of Male Violence*. London: Routledge.

Stanko, Elizabeth A. 1993. “The Case of Fearful Women.” *Women & Criminal Justice* 4 (1): 117–135. doi:10.1300/J012v04n01_06.

Stark, Evan. 2012. “Looking Beyond Domestic Violence: Policing Coercive Control.” *Journal of Police Crisis Negotiations* 12 (2): 199–217. doi:10.1080/15332586.2012.725016.

Théorêt, Valérie, Martine Hébert, Mylène Fernet, and Martin Blais. 2020. “Gender-Specific Patterns of Teen Dating Violence in Heterosexual Relationships and Their Associations with Attachment Insecurities and Emotion Dysregulation.” *Journal of Youth and Adolescence* 50 (2): 246–259. doi:10.1007/s10964-020-01328-5.

Thompson, Laura. 2018. ““I Can Be Your Tinder Nightmare”: Harassment and Misogyny in the Online Sexual Marketplace.” *Feminism & Psychology* 28 (1): 69–89. doi:10.1177/0959353517720226.

Tinder Nightmares. 2021. “Instagram.” https://www.instagram.com/tindernightmares/
Tolman, Deborah L. 2002. *Dilemmas of Desire: Teenage Girls Talk about Sexuality*. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press.

Tolman, Deborah L., Brian R. Davis, and Christian P. Bowman. 2016. ““That’s Just How It Is”: A Gendered Analysis of Masculinity and Femininity Ideologies in Adolescent Girls and Boys Heterosexual Relationships.” *Journal of Adolescent Research* 31 (1): 3–31. doi:10.1177/0743558415587325.

Van der Nagel, Emily. 2017. “From Usernames to Profiles: The Development of Pseudonymity in Internet Communication.” *Internet Histories* 1 (4): 312–331. doi:10.1080/24701475.2017.1389548. Vera-Gray, Fiona. 2014. “The Great Problems are in the Street: A Phenomenology of Men’s Stranger Intrusions on Women in Public Space.” PhD thesis, London Metropolitan University. http://repository.londonmet.ac.uk/1079/

Vera-Gray, Fiona. 2016. “‘Situating Agency.’ Trouble and Strife.” Accessed 20 March 2020. http://www.troubleandstrife.org/2016/05/situating-agency/

Vera-Gray, Fiona. 2017. "'Talk about a Cunt with Too Much Idle Time': Trolling Feminist Research." *Feminist Review* 115 (1): 61–78. doi:10.1057/s41305-017-0038-y.
Vera-Gray, Fiona. 2018. *The Right Amount of Panic: How Women Trade Freedom for Safety*. Bristol: Bristol University Press.

Vitak, Jessica, Kalyani Chadha, Linda Steiner, and Zahra Ashktorab. 2017. "Identifying Women's Experiences with and Strategies for Mitigating Negative Effects of Online Harassment." Paper Presented at the ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing, Portland, Oregon, February 25 – March 1, 2017.

Watkins, Adam M. 2005. "Examining the Disparity between Juvenile and Adult Victims in Notifying the Police: A Study of Mediating Variables." *Journal of Research in Crime and Delinquency* 42 (3): 333–353. doi:10.1177/0022427805275186.

West, Sarah Myers. 2018. "Censored, Suspended, Shadowbanned: User Interpretations of Content Moderation on Social Media Platforms." *New Media and Society* 20 (11): 4366–4383. doi:10.1177/1461444818773059.